Eric C. So

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RESEARCH INTERESTS:

Artificial intelligence, asset pricing and trading, behavioral economics, regulatory policy.

ACADEMICS:

▷ Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), Cambridge, Massachusetts USA

Sloan Distinguished Professor of Global Economics and Behavioral Science
Global Economics and Management Group
Jamieson Teaching Fellow, May 2020 - Present
Faculty Co-Director, AI Executive Academy (2024 - Present)
Lead Faculty, MIT Sloan Generative AI Hub for Teaching and Learning (2023 - Present)
Research Group Lead, AI, Finance & Decisions Group, MIT IDE
Teaching: AI Foundations, Alphanomics, Global Business of AI & Robotics

▷ Stanford University, Stanford, California USA

Ph.D., Business Administration, 2012

▷ Cornell University, Ithaca, New York USA

M.A., Economics, 2005

▷ University of Maryland, College Park, Maryland USA

B.A., Economics, 2003

BOOK:

"The Collision: What AI Does to Us"

- Published by W. W. Norton, 2026 (solo-authored)
- AI is not just changing what we do, it is changing who we are as thinkers. This book examines the collision between artificial intelligence and human cognition: how our growing reliance on AI tools is quietly reshaping memory, judgment, learning, and even how we see the world around us.

RESEARCH:

Topic: AI and Technology

1. "Loyalty Capture: Reporting Relationships and Structural Sycophancy in Frontier AI Models"
   - Accepted at *NeurIPS 2026*, Main Track
   - Coauthor: Alex Imas

2. "The Profit Alignment Problem: How Profit Mandates Induce Alignment Failures in LLMs"
    - Accepted at the *Conference on Language Models (COLM)* [2026]
    - Solo-authored paper

3. "Lost in Context: Addressing Context Anxiety in Large Language Models"
    - *Proceedings of the 43rd International Conference on Machine Learning*, Seoul, South Korea. PMLR 306, 2026.
    - Coauthors: Ifueko Igbinedion, Jillian Ross, Etienne Ricardez, and Sertac Karaman

4. "Mitigating Agentic Misalignment via Jacobian Workspace Self-Supervision"
    - Working Paper [2026]
    - Coauthors: Ifueko Igbinedion, Etienne Ricardez, and Sertac Karaman

5. "Adding AI Advice to Trading Interfaces Induces Overtrading and Reduces Investor Welfare"
    - Working Paper [2026]
    - Coauthors: Zoe De Simone, Etienne Ricárdez, and Andrew W. Lo

6. "AI Advisors and the Competence-Judgment Tradeoff in Information Disclosure"
    - Available on *SSRN* [January 2026]
    - Coauthors: Abigail Sussman and Fiona Y. Yang

7. "Breaking Bad Financial Habits: How LLM Conversations Correct Financial Misconceptions"
    - Available on *arXiv* [April 2026]
    - Coauthors: Jillian Ross and Andrew W. Lo

8. "The Fiscal Frontier: Projecting AI's Long-term Impact on the US Fiscal Outlook"
    - Published by the *Brookings Institution Center on Regulation and Markets* [Feb 2025]
    - Coauthors: Benjamin H. Harris and Neil Mehrotra

Topic: Behavioral and Financial Economics

1. "Box Jumping: Portfolio Recompositions to Achieve Higher Morningstar Ratings"
    - Accepted at *Journal of Financial Economics*
    - Coauthors: Lauren Cohen and David S. Kim

2. "Bad News Bearers: The Negative Tilt of the Financial Press"
    - Published in *Management Science* [Articles in Advance (September 2026)]
    - Coauthors: Betty Liu and Marina Niessner

3. "Losing Is Optional: Retail Option Trading and Expected Announcement Volatility"
    - Published in *Review of Finance* [30(2): 489-535 (March 2026)]
    - Coauthors: Tim de Silva and Kevin Smith

4. "Investor Corporate Visits and Predictable Returns"
   - Published in *Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis* [60(6): 2615-2648 (September 2025)]
   - Coauthors: Ran Zhang and Rongfei Wang

5. "Flight to Earnings: The Role of Earnings in Periods of Capital Scarcity"
   - Published in *Management Science* [69(8): 4908-4931 (August 2023)]
   - Coauthors: Nick Guest and SP Kothari

6. "Core Earnings: New Data and Evidence"
   - Published in the *Journal of Financial Economics* [142(3): 1068-1091 (December 2021)]
   - Coauthors: Ethan Rouen and Charles Wang

7. "Calendar Rotations: A New Approach for Studying the Impact of Timing Using Earnings Announcements"
   - Published in the *Journal of Financial Economics* [140(3): 865-893 (June 2021)]
   - Coauthors: Suzie Noh and Rodrigo Verdi

8. "Evaluating Firm-Level Expected-Return Proxies: Implications for Estimating Treatment Effects"
   - Published in the *Review of Financial Studies* [34(4): 1907-1951 (April 2021)]
   - Coauthors: Charles Lee and Charles Wang

9. "Expectations Management and Stock Returns"
   - Published in the *Review of Financial Studies* [33(10): 4580-4626 (October 2020)]
   - Coauthors: Travis Johnson and Jinhwan Kim

10. "A Simple Multimarket Measure of Information Asymmetry"
    - Published in *Management Science* [64(3): 1055-1080 (March 2018)]
    - Coauthor: Travis Johnson

11. "Time Will Tell: Information in the Timing of Scheduled Earnings News"
    - Published in the *Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis* [53(6): 2431-2464 (December 2018)]
    - Coauthor: Travis Johnson

12. "News-Driven Return Reversals: Liquidity Provision Ahead of Earnings Announcements"
    - Published in the *Journal of Financial Economics* [114(1): 20-35 (October 2014)]
    - Coauthor: S. Wang

13. "A New Approach to Predicting Analyst Forecast Errors: Do Investors Overweight Analyst Forecasts?"
    - Published in the *Journal of Financial Economics* [108(3): 615-640 (June 2013)]
    - Solo-Authored; Stanford University Dissertation

14. "Identifying Expectation Errors in Value/Glamour Strategies: A Fundamental Analysis Approach"
    - Published in the *Review of Financial Studies* [25(9): 2841-2875 (2012)]
    - Coauthor: Joe Piotroski

15. "The Option to Stock Volume Ratio and Future Returns"
    - Published in the *Journal of Financial Economics* [106(2): 262-286 (November 2012)]
    - Coauthor: Travis Johnson

Topic: Measurement, Regulation, and Disclosure

1. "Financial Reporting and Consumer Behavior"
    - Published in *The Accounting Review* [100(1): 407-435 (January 2025)]
    - Coauthors: Suzie Noh and Christina Zhu

2. "Conflicts of Interest in Subscriber-Paid Credit Ratings"
    - Published in the *Journal of Accounting and Economics* [77(1): Article 101614 (February 2024)]
    - Coauthors: Sam Bonsall, Jacquelyn Gillette, Gabriel Pundrich

3. "Measuring Risk Information"
    - Published in the *Journal of Accounting Research* [60(2): 375-426 (May 2022)]
    - Coauthors: Kevin Smith

4. "Voluntary and Mandatory Disclosures: Do Managers View Them as Substitutes?"
    - Published in the *Journal of Accounting and Economics* [68(1): Article 101243 (August 2019)]
    - Coauthors: Suzie Noh and Joe Weber

5. "Asymmetric Trading Costs Prior to Earnings Announcements: Implications for Price Discovery and Returns"
    - Published in the *Journal of Accounting Research* [56(1): 217-263 (March 2018)]
    - Coauthor: Travis Johnson

6. "Non-Diversifiable Volatility Risk and Risk Premiums at Earnings Announcements"
    - Published in *The Accounting Review* [89(5): 1579-1607 (September 2014)]
    - Coauthor: Mary Barth

7. "Boardroom Centrality and Firm Performance"
    - Published in the *Journal of Accounting and Economics* [55(2-3): 225-250 (April-May 2013)]
    - Coauthors: Dave Larcker and Charles Wang

8. "Analyst Initiations of Coverage and Stock Return Synchronicity"
    - Published in *The Accounting Review* [87(5): 1527-1553 (September 2012)]
    - Coauthors: Steve Crawford and Darren Roulstone

Topic: Labor Economics

1. "Inside the Black Box of Doctoral Education: What Program Characteristics Influence Doctoral Students' Attrition and Graduation Probabilities?"
   - Published in *Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis* [29(2): 134-150 (June 2007)]
   - Coauthors: Ron Ehrenberg, George Jakubson, Jeffrey Groen, Joseph Price

Topic: Surveys and Monographs

1. "Teaching and Learning Economics with AI: A Guide"
   - Chapter in *The Ultimate Guide to Teaching Economics* [W. W. Norton, 2025]

2. "Analysts' Forecasts and Asset Pricing: A Survey"
   - Published in the *Annual Review of Financial Economics* [8: 197-219 (2016)]
   - Coauthors: SP Kothari and Rodrigo Verdi

3. "Alphanomics: The Informational Underpinnings of Market Efficiency"
   - Published in *Foundations and Trends in Accounting* [9(2-3): 59-258 (2015)]
   - Coauthor: Charles Lee

RESEARCH-IN-PROGRESS:

- "Fee the People" with Omri Even-Tov, Kimberlyn George, and Shimon Kogan

PRIOR WORK EXPERIENCE:

▷ Nasdaq Stock Market, Rockville, Maryland USA — Aug. 2005 - June 2007
Research Analyst, Nasdaq Economic Research Department

OUTSIDE ENGAGEMENTS:

▷ Academic Advisor, Fuller-Thaler Asset Management (2017-Present)
▷ Consultant, Wellington Asset Management (2020-2022)
▷ Consultant, Robinhood Financial (2022)
▷ Member, Listing Council for Nasdaq Stock Market (2018-2020)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

▷ MIT Sloan:

- Faculty Director of MIT Sloan PhD Program (Oct 2022 - Present)
- Committee Member, Committee on Undergraduate Admissions and Financial Aid (2022-Present)
- Committee Member, Faculty Data Research Committee (2017-Present)

▷ Dissertation Committees:

- Committee Chair: Nick Guest (Cornell University 2018), Jinhwan Kim (Stanford University 2019), Suzie Noh (Stanford University 2020), Georg Rickman (Northwestern University 2020), Sam Anderson (Michigan, expected 2022), Ki-Soon Choi (Boston College, 2022), Gabriel Voelker (Dartmouth, 2024)
- Committee Member: Patricia Naranjo (Rice, 2014), Josh Anderson (Boston University, 2015), Ben Yost (Boston College, 2017), Tim de Silva (Stanford, 2024)

▷ Editorial Experience:

- Management Science (MS), Department Editor [Nov. 2021 - Present], Associate Editor [Sep. 2018 - Oct. 2021]
- Journal of Accounting Research (JAR), Associate Editor [Jan. 2019 - Oct. 2021]

▷ Referee Service:

- Quarterly Journal of Economics (QJE), Journal of Finance (JF), Journal of Financial Economics (JFE), Review of Financial Studies (RFS), Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis (JFQA), Management Science (MS), Review of Finance (RoF), Journal of Accounting and Economics (JAE), Journal of Accounting Research (JAR), The Accounting Review (TAR), Review of Accounting Studies (RAST), Contemporary Accounting Research (CAR)